

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 5 · The Judicial Branch (GC.19–GC.22)

Match the task to the tool —
then teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put steps in order / show a process	● Timeline · Sequence	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes how one step makes the next possible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem–Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national civics stick — and it's what sets Government Hack apart. Our signature move.

Social Studies Practices Crosswalk

Unit 3 · The Legislative Branch (SSP.01) Unit 2 · Citizen Participation (SSP.01–SSP.06)

Every organizer doubles as a *skills tool*.

The Tennessee **Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–06)** are the skills every unit must build. This crosswalk maps each practice to the organizers that develop it — and shows **where** it lives in Unit 5 — so a graphic organizer is never busywork: it is deliberate practice toward a standard.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO (TN SSP)	ORGANIZERS THAT BUILD IT	WHERE IN UNIT 5
● SSP.01	Collect data & information from a variety of primary and secondary sources.	5 Ws · Main Idea & Details · K-W-L	GC.19 Article III power (Main Idea & Details); K-W-L to open.
● SSP.02	Critically examine a source: purpose, point of view, evidence vs. assertion, bias.	HIPPO · C-E-R	GC.21 Marbury v. Madison (HIPPO / source analysis of the opinion).
● SSP.03	Synthesize data from several sources; compare accounts; frame new questions.	Comparison Matrix · Concept Web · Venn	GC.22 activism vs. restraint (T-Chart); court process (Sequence).
● SSP.04	Construct & communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.	C-E-R · T-Chart · Problem–Solution	GC.22 activism vs. restraint (T-Chart); C-E-R on judicial review.
● SSP.05	Develop historical awareness: cause, context, continuity & change over time.	Timeline · Cause & Effect · Sequence	GC.20 selection & confirmation (Sequence); GC.21 Marbury (Cause & Effect).
● SSP.06	Develop geographic awareness: patterns and scale from local to national.	Tennessee Connection · Matrix	Limited in Foundations; primary geographic focus lands in Unit 7 (TN State & Local). Use the ★ Tennessee Connection to bridge.

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Two

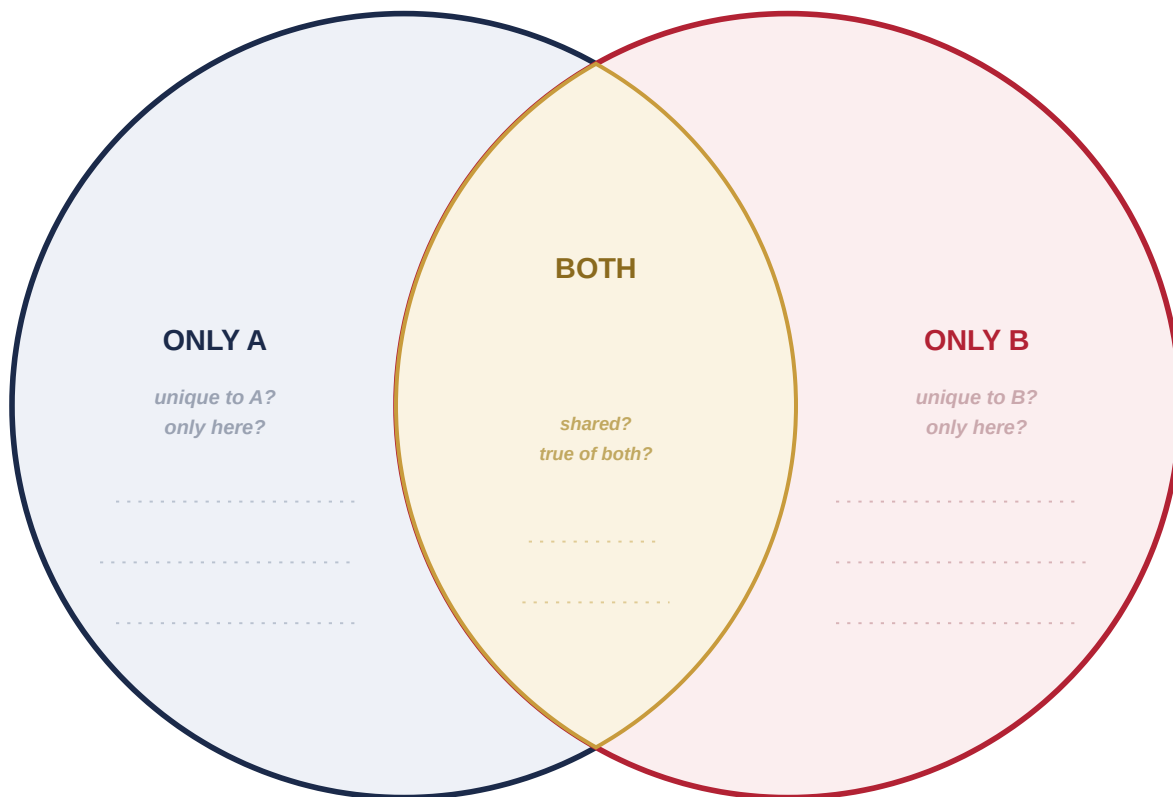
Marzano #1

WHEN · WHY Reach for a Venn when students compare **two** things: the overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Write what makes each unique in its own circle — and what they share in the middle.

Topic A: _____
write in the left circle

Topic B: _____
write in the right circle



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SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

EXTEND

Use the overlap to write one sentence explaining what the two share at a deeper level.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Three

Synthesis

WHEN · WHY Use a three-circle Venn to compare **three** things at once and find what any two — or all three — share.
Synthesizing across sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.

Place each example in the right region. What belongs to one, to a pair, or to all three?

● **Topic 1**

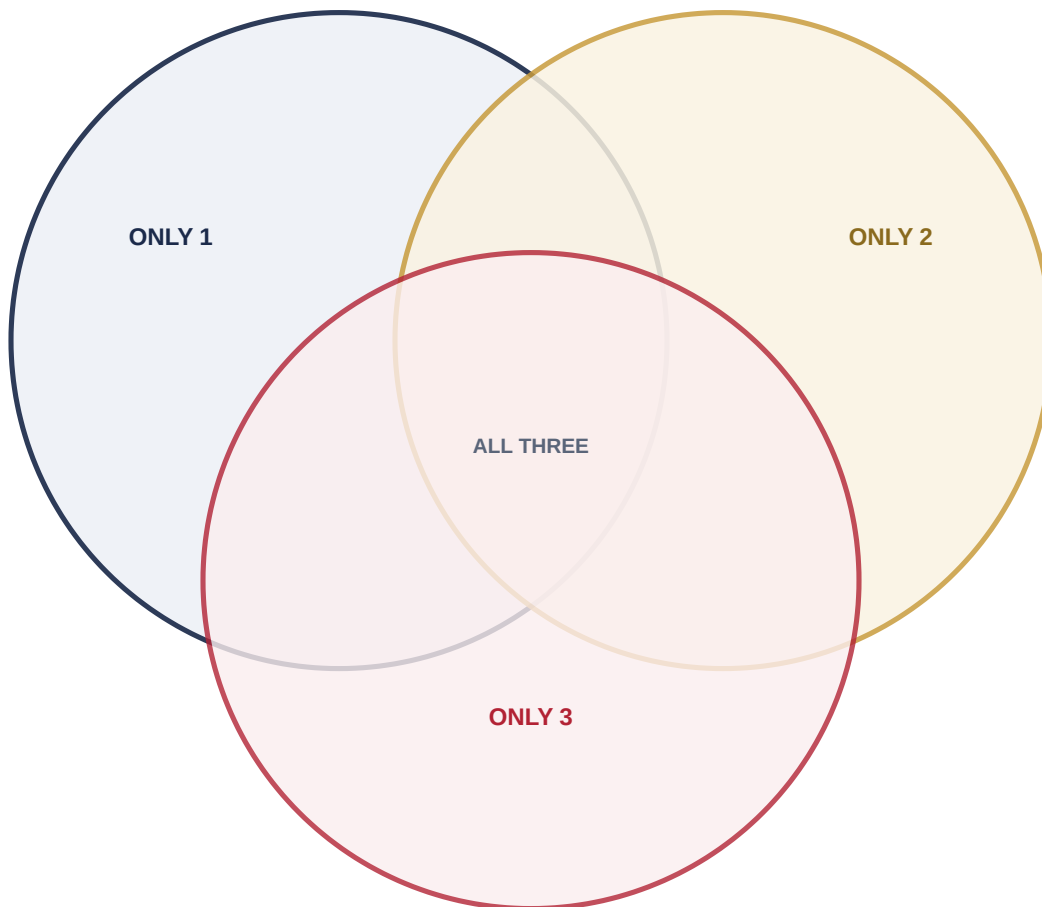
write examples in the circle

● **Topic 2**

write examples in the circle

● **Topic 3**

write examples in the circle



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SCAFFOLD

Start by placing three sure examples — one clearly in each 'only' region — then work toward the overlaps.

EXTEND

Explain why the center region (all three) is the hardest to fill — what must be true there?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

Gather evidence on each side — then use the bottom line to decide.

WHEN · WHY When students compare **three or more** cases against the same criteria, a matrix holds them to one yardstick so patterns pop. *Structured comparison is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Fill each cell, then read down each column and across each row for patterns.

	Case 1 name it	Case 2 name it	Case 3 name it
Criterion A			
Criterion B			
Criterion C			
PATTERN	What pattern do you see across the cases? _____		

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SCAFFOLD
Fill one full row together so students see how to compare across the same criterion.

EXTEND
Add a fourth case or a fourth criterion and predict where it would fall.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Cause & Effect

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect

SSP.05

WHEN · WHY Trace the chain of **why** something happened and what followed. *Cause-and-effect reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.05.*

List what led up to the event on the left; list what it set in motion on the right.

CAUSES

WHAT CONDITIONS MADE IT HAPPEN?

EFFECTS

WHAT DID IT LEAD TO?

THE EVENT
name it

So what? Which single cause mattered most, and why?

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Provide two causes and two effects on cards; students place and then add one of each.

EXTEND

Draw an arrow from one effect to a new cause: how did one result trigger the next?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Timeline — Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline

SSP.05 Chronology

WHEN · WHY Put events **in order** to expose how one step made the next possible. *Chronological reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Write each date on the left, then explain why the event mattered.

Event 1 — what happened?

write the date

Event 2 — what happened?

Event 3 — what happened?

Event 4 — why did it matter?

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SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards; students order them on the spine first, then add significance.

EXTEND

Add arrows between nodes to show cause & effect across the sequence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Concept Web

⌚ 10-15 min

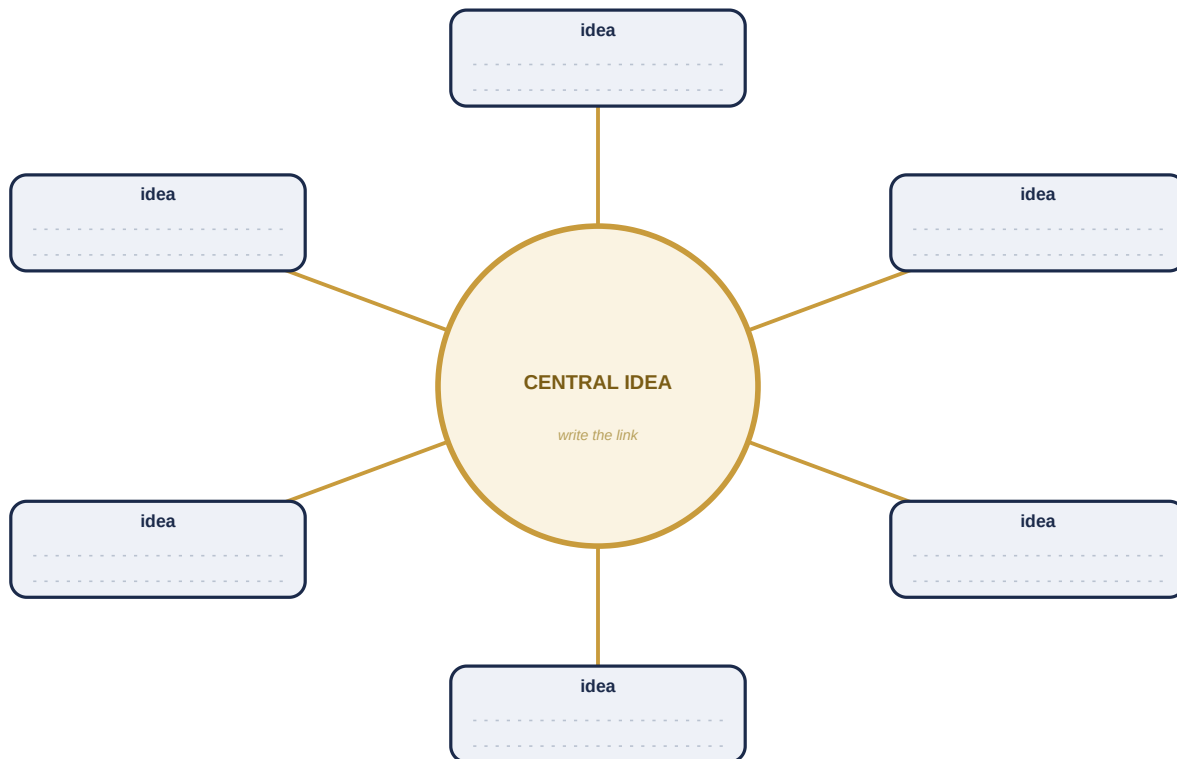
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web

Schema

WHEN · WHY **Brainstorm** and connect ideas around one central concept — it surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to a hub. *Building schema is a UDL comprehension support.*

Write the central idea in the hub, then fill each bubble with a connected idea — and name the link.



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SCAFFOLD

Fill two bubbles together and model naming the link on the connecting line.

EXTEND

Draw a line between two outer bubbles that connect to each other, not just to the hub.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Main Idea & Details

Summarize

Write the main idea on top; add supporting details below; then sum it up in one line.

MAIN IDEA

[illegible]

In one sentence: the main idea matters because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

Give the main idea and have students hunt only for the supporting details.

Rank the details from strongest to weakest support and justify the top one.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Fill K and W before you start; return to L after the lesson.

[illegible]

UDL · MTSS

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

5 Ws

⌚ 5-10 min

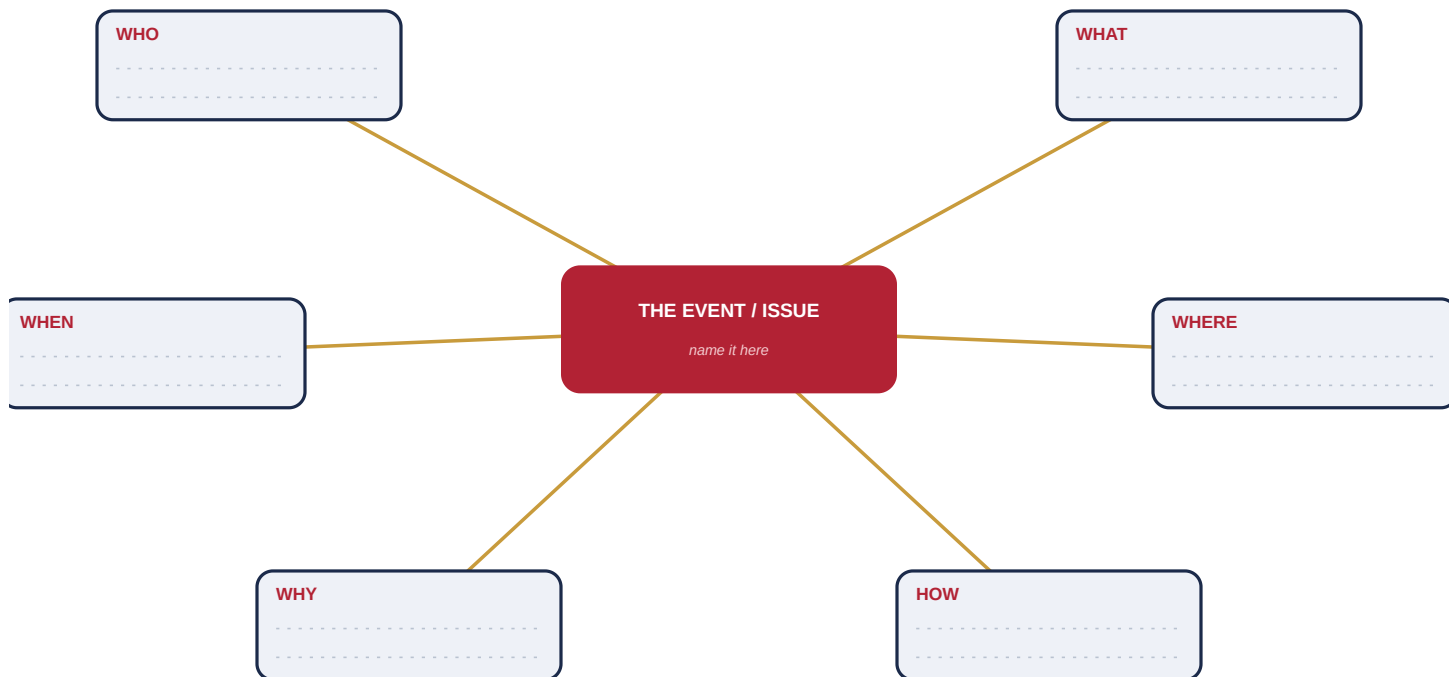
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

5 Ws

SSP.01

WHEN · WHY Capture the **basics of an event** fast — who, what, when, where, why (and how). *Collecting information from sources is TN Practice SSP.01.*

Name the event or issue in the center, then answer each question around it.

**MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT** UDL · MTSS**SCAFFOLD**

Assign each question to a partner pair, then combine into one shared chart.

EXTEND

Turn the 'Why' and 'How' answers into a single cause-and-effect sentence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Problem & Solution

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Problem-Solution

Decision

WHEN · WHY Weigh options against a defined problem and decide with evidence, naming each trade-off. *Devising and defending solutions builds SSP.04.*

State the problem, sketch two possible solutions with their trade-offs, then decide.

THE PROBLEM

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM, EXACTLY?

Option A: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Option B: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Best solution: _____ — because _____

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SCAFFOLD

Provide one worked solution with its trade-off; students generate the second.

EXTEND

Add a third option and rank all three by which trade-off is easiest to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Learn a key term deeply: definition, characteristics, examples, and non-examples — not a definition forgotten by Friday. *Robust vocabulary work is Marzano's six-step method.*

Write the term in the center, then complete all four corners.

DEFINITION (in your words)	CHARACTERISTICS (must-have traits)
TERM write the term	
EXAMPLES	EXAMPLES

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SCAFFOLD
Give the definition; students generate the examples and non-examples.

EXTEND
Write one sentence that uses the term correctly in a new context.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Claim – Evidence – Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

C-E-R

SSP.04 Argument

WHEN · WHY Turn an opinion into a **defensible argument**: a claim, the evidence for it, and the reasoning that ties them.
Constructing evidence-based arguments is TN Practice SSP.04.

Answer the question with a claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning.

CLAIM — answer the question in one sentence

ONE CLEAR SENTENCE

EVIDENCE — specific facts / quotations that support the claim

QUOTE / FACT 1 ... QUOTE / FACT 2

REASONING — why the evidence proves the claim

HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE PROVE THE CLAIM?
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SCAFFOLD

Provide a claim stem and one piece of evidence; students supply the reasoning.

EXTEND

Add a counter-claim and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

HIPPO

SSP.02

WHEN · WHY Give students a historian's routine for **interrogating a source**: context, audience, point of view, purpose, outside information. *Critically examining sources is TN Practice SSP.02.*

Record the source, then work through each element to analyze it.

Source: _____ title · author / creator · date · type

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What was happening when this was made?

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE

Who was meant to see or read it?

P

POINT OF VIEW

Who made it — and how does that shape it?

P

PURPOSE

Why was it made? What did it want to do?

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION

What do you know that connects to it?

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SCAFFOLD

Model H and I together on a shared source before students do P, P, O.

EXTEND

Use the O row to connect this source to another document you have studied.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Tennessee Connection

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

✓ REPRODUCIBLE

⌚ 10-15 min

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

★ TN Connection

Signature Move

WHEN · WHY Connect the **nation** to **Tennessee** — local ties make national civics stick. This is our signature move.
Relevance and connection to students' lives is a UDL engagement principle.

Note the national idea on the left and its Tennessee counterpart on the right, then link them.

NATIONAL



★ CONNECTS TO

TENNESSEE

How are they linked? _____

Why the local story matters: _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT		
UDL · MTSS		
SCAFFOLD Give the national example; students find the Tennessee counterpart with a provided source.	EXTEND Explain how the Tennessee case is similar to <i>and</i> different from the national one.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write , say (record), draw , or build their response.

Article III — The Judicial Power

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Main Idea & Details

DOK 2 · Summarize

WHEN · WHY Article III sketches the judicial branch in a few lines. Pulling out its key features shows students how the Framers protected judges' independence. *Separating central idea from supporting detail builds disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Main idea: what Article III establishes. Fill each column with the detail from the text.

ARTICLE III — the judicial power of the United States

One Supreme Court	'Good Behaviour' tenure	Jurisdiction
WHAT DOES CONGRESS GET TO CREATE?	HOW DOES LIFE TENURE PROTECT INDEPENDENCE?	ORIGINAL VS. APPELLATE — HOW DO CASES ARRIVE?

In one sentence: How does Article III keep judges independent of politics?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD Give the three details as cards; students match each to the right column first.	EXTEND Explain how a federal judge is removed, and why it is so rare.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write , say (record), draw , or build their response.
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Seating a Supreme Court Justice

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Sequence · Process Flow

SSP.05 · DOK 2

WHEN · WHY A justice reaches the bench through a shared process no one branch controls. Mapping the steps shows students exactly where the President's power ends and the Senate's begins. *Sequencing a process builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).*

Work down the process. Note who controls each step.

A seat opens — *what creates a Supreme Court vacancy?*

1

The President NOMINATES — *how does the President choose a nominee?*

2

Senate Judiciary Committee HEARINGS — *what does the committee ask the nominee?*

3

The full Senate CONFIRMS (majority vote) — *the 'Advice and Consent' check — then the justice is seated for life*

4

Why so high-stakes? A justice can serve for decades — how does that raise the stakes of one confirmation? _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide the four steps on cards; students order them, then label who controls each.

EXTEND

Explain why a single appointment can shape the law long after a President leaves office.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

How Marbury Created Judicial Review

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect • Chain

SSP.02 • DOK 3

WHEN • WHY The Court claimed its greatest power in a single 1803 case. Tracing the chain of Marshall's reasoning shows students where judicial review actually comes from. *Examining a source's reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.02.*

Work down Marshall's reasoning in *Marbury v. Madison* (1803).

1 The dispute (1803) — *a law and the Constitution seemed to conflict — which one wins?*

2 Marshall's reasoning — *'it is... the province and duty of the judicial department to say what the law is' — what does he claim?*

3 The rule — *'a law repugnant to the constitution is void' — what happens to a conflicting law?*

4 The effect: **JUDICIAL REVIEW** — *how did this make the courts a check on the other branches?*

So what? The Constitution never lists this power — was Marshall right to claim it?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the four steps on cards; students order Marshall's logic before writing effects.

EXTEND

Explain how judicial review connects to the checks & balances you studied in Unit 1.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY How boldly should judges use their power? The standard asks students to weigh two philosophies. A T-chart collects evidence for each before a reasoned judgment. *Constructing arguments from evidence builds TN Practice SSP.04.*

Sort each idea or case, then decide which approach the courts should favor.

JUDICIAL ACTIVISM living Constitution; willing to act View of the Constitution a 'living document' that adapts? Willingness to strike laws more willing to overturn a law? An example ruling a case that fits this approach?	JUDICIAL RESTRAINT original intent; defer to elected branches View of the Constitution read by its 'original intent'? Deference defer to Congress & precedent? An example ruling a case that fits this approach?
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Your verdict: Which approach should the Court favor — because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD Sort a set of statement cards into Activism vs. Restraint before writing.	EXTEND Honors: place the Warren, Burger, Rehnquist, or Roberts Court on the activism–restraint spectrum with evidence.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write, say (record), draw , or build their response.
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